on your mortgage, by allowing you to borrow between 5% and 20% (40% in London) of the value of the property as a loan, which is interest free for the first five years and is repaid alongside your mortgage.

NB: all the above have pros and cons. For more information about any of these schemes, see www.gov.uk/affordable-home-ownership-schemes.

Fixed-term Savings

For a non-government-backed option, you can often get better rates on savings accounts that don't allow you to withdraw for a certain period – usually at least two years. As long as you can be pretty certain that you won't need the money in the meantime, this can be a smart choice: higher interest and it's locked away.

The key, really, with saving for an important, long-term financial goal is to be patient and determined, but not to let it take over every second of the intervening weeks, months and (potentially) years. Allow it to be a pot that you keep simmering on the back hob, knowing that, when it's finally ready, it will taste amazing. Ensure that you're checking in every now and again, and celebrate when you reach certain milestones, even if you're not quite at the end yet. Saving £5,000 or £10,000 is a huge achievement – it doesn't matter if you're not even halfway to the end goal yet. Celebrating these wins will give